ELDERS QUORUM & RELIEF SOCIETY · 25 MIN

The Sculpting of Our Souls

Sister Tamara W. Runia · October 2026 general conference

Weekly 25-minute meeting (since Sept. 6, 2026). Begin and end with prayer, start the discussion quickly, and counsel together during the lesson. There is no separate counseling topic beforehand.

ONE CORE TRUTH

God sculpts our souls through the very things that make life hard; invite Him to do His work.

0:00–2:00

Welcome & prayer · Presidency

- A simple welcome, then invite someone to give the opening prayer.
- Keep business to what can't wait; no separate counseling topic. Then start right away.

2:00–5:00

Open · Teacher

- Ask: Where am I still asking “why” instead of “what is supposed to be happening here?”
- Invite someone to read: “God’s love has moved me from questions that begin with ‘why’ to reflections that begin, ‘I know that God loves me, so what is supposed to be happening here?’”
- Give a quiet moment to ponder before anyone answers.

5:00–20:00

Discuss one core truth · Everyone

- Q1. Read Doctrine and Covenants 122:7 together. How does it help us understand this truth about following Jesus Christ?
- Q2. When have you seen this truth at work in your own life or family?
- Optional, about 3 min: Turn to someone nearby and share your answer to Q2, then invite two or three people to share with everyone.
- Q3. What challenges or opportunities in our ward does this speak to? How could we help one another, including through our ministering and in our homes?
- Let members answer one another. Resist answering every question yourself.

20:00–24:00

Invite, testify, follow up · Teacher

- From the talk: Invite God to do His sculpting work. He can fix what feels badly broken.
- Ask: “What do you feel impressed to do?” Give a minute to write it down privately.
- Bear brief testimony of Jesus Christ and this truth, or invite someone to.
- Next week, open by inviting one or two people to share how it went.

24:00–25:00

Closing prayer · Presidency

- Invite someone to give the closing prayer. End on time.

BEFORE SUNDAY

Tempering, refining experiences are part of necessary mortal growth — “all these things shall give thee experience.” The gospel isn't an umbrella that keeps the rain off; it's the solid rock we stand on during the storm. A godlike life is carved from the very things that make it hard, and God waits for our invitation before He really goes to work. She shared the sudden death of her son, a young father.

- Read the full talk and pray about what your quorum or Relief Society needs from it.
- Share the talk link a few days early so members come having read it.
- Teach one truth well. Meaningful discussion matters more than covering everything.
- Other scriptures the talk cites: Helaman 5:12; Galatians 3:27; 1 Nephi 11:16, 17; 1 John 3:2

Timing follows the Church's 25-minute meeting guidance; adapt it as the Spirit directs. Read the full talk at ChurchofJesusChrist.org.